HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I can't trust anyone in authority"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I can't trust anyone in authority." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who hurt my trust?
- ☐ Who was trustworthy?
- ☐ What is discernment?
- ☐ What does Scripture say?
- ☐ Where is my trust?
- ☐ What small test?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I must obey God above men.
- ☐ I can be shrewd and innocent.
- ☐ The prudent watch their steps.
- ☐ Not all authorities are the same.
- ☐ I can give trust in small steps.
- ☐ God is always trustworthy.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Matthew 10:16
  "Behold, I am sending you out like sheep among wolves; therefore be as shrewd as snakes and as innocent as doves."
- ☐ Proverbs 14:15
  "The simple man believes every word, but the prudent man watches his steps."
- ☐ Acts 5:29
  "But Peter and the other apostles replied, 'We must obey God rather than men.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Discernment, not distrust: Each week, note one authority you assessed fairly.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Matthew 10:16 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I can be shrewd and innocent, and trust God above all.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Trust" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Name the hurt. Write who hurt your trust and what happened.
- [ ] List trustworthy ones. Write any authority who earned your respect.
- [ ] Test small. Trust someone with something small.
- [ ] Pray for wisdom. Ask for discernment.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I can't trust anyone in authority": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Discernment, not distrust
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I can't trust anyone in authority.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I was hurt by those in charge. Heal my trust, give me discernment, and help me trust You above all, who never fail. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.